

times grossly exaggerated.

2.2.3 Statistics generators

There are basically two kinds of programs that “generate”—or survey and record—statistics of traffic to a Web site: the ones which monitor sites “dynamically” and the ones that study the log files of Web servers.

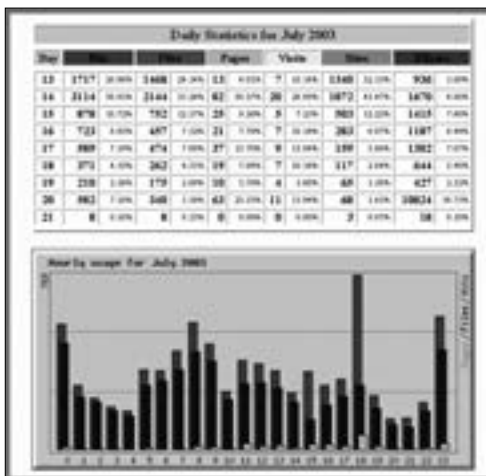
1. Dynamic Monitoring

The monitoring of number of visitors to a Web site in real-time is known as Dynamic Monitoring. Usually, a Web site counter shows the number of hits of the page, and this number is updated every time a new visitor accesses the site. This usually takes the form of a “counter,” or an image (an advertising banner, for example) that is placed on the main page of the site. When your browser requests the image, a program is executed (usually a CGI script or server-side application) which records the IP address from which your request is coming, and then returns the image to the same address. This is great for identifying the different IP addresses that have visited the site.

Usually, a hit counter is a good option for sites that don’t have a Web server of their own, and therefore cannot access the more reliable server log files.

2. Analysis of Web logs

Every time a Web site is accessed, a request is actually made to a server for that particular site to be accessed.



A Web tracking software typically produces a fancy report like this one